

State of Vermont

House of Representatives



Montpelier, Vermont

Joint House Resolution

J.R.H. 7

Offered by Representatives Greer of Bennington, Austin of Colchester, Bos-Lun of Westminster, Brady of Williston, Burke of Brattleboro, Cina of Burlington, Conlon of Cornwall, Dodge of Essex, Donahue of Northfield, Duke of Burlington, Eastes of Guilford, Garofano of Essex, Goldman of Rockingham, Headrick of Burlington, Howard of Rutland City, Kleppner of Burlington, Lalley of Shelburne, Lipsky of Stowe, Masland of Thetford, McCann of Montpelier, Morrow of Weston, Nelson of Derby, Page of Newport City, Pouech of Hinesburg, Satcowitz of Randolph, Sibia of Dover, Tomlinson of Winooski, and White of Bethel

Joint resolution strongly supporting the existing U.S.-Denmark treaty related to Greenland and opposing American efforts to secure sovereignty over the island

Whereas, Greenland, the world's largest noncontinental island, is located between the Arctic and Atlantic Oceans and shares a short border with Canada on Hans Island, and

Whereas, since 1814, the nation of Denmark (a NATO ally of the United States) has governed Greenland, first as a colony, then in 1979 as a semiautonomous territory of the Danish nation, and in 2008 the voters of Greenland extended the island's authority to exercise self-governance on domestic matters, and

Whereas, Greenlanders are engaged in a long-term democratic political process to determine the island's independence status, and

Whereas, on April 9, 1940, following the Nazi occupation of Denmark, the United States quietly entered into an agreement with the Danish ambassador to Washington for an American military presence on the island and to maintain allied control of Greenland, and

Whereas, on April 9, 1941, this initial agreement was memorialized and signed as Thulesag 1, and, that year, American military personnel and equipment were deployed to the island, and

Whereas, on April 27, 1951, the United States and the Kingdom of Denmark entered into a new Defense of Greenland Agreement with reference to each country's membership in NATO, and on August 6, 2004, the two nations amended the agreement to update the text, and

Whereas, the United States maintains Pituffik Space Base in northern Greenland, which is a strategically critical location to monitor any Russian missile launches over the Arctic, and

Whereas, on Sunday, January 4, 2026, in the aftermath of the American military invasion of Venezuela, President Trump stated, "Right now,

Greenland is covered with Russian and Chinese ships all over the place. We need Greenland from the standpoint of national security,” and

Whereas, White House Deputy Chief of Staff Stephen Miller, in a CNN interview, declared that the United States had the right to seize Greenland if it so desired, and

Whereas, President Trump appointed Louisiana Governor Jeff Landry as a special envoy to Greenland, claiming that the United States needs Greenland for “national protection” and that “we have to have it,” and

Whereas, in response to President Trump’s statements regarding the U.S.-Denmark-Greenland military collaboration, Danish Prime Minister Mette Frederiksen remarked that the existing treaty gave the United States “wide access to Greenland,” and she “strongly urge[d] the United States to stop the threats against [Denmark,] a historically close ally,” and

Whereas, subsequently, Prime Minister Frederiksen warned President Trump, in no uncertain terms, that an American military attack on Greenland would result in the end of the NATO alliance, and on Tuesday, January 6, 2026, the leaders of France, Germany, Italy, Poland, Spain, and the United Kingdom, along with Prime Minister Frederiksen, released a statement emphasizing the importance of NATO to Arctic security, and

Whereas, Prime Minister Jens-Frederik Nielsen of Greenland wrote on social media that President Trump’s desire for American control of Greenland was “utterly unacceptable,” and

Whereas, U.S. sovereignty over Greenland is not a prerequisite for the awarding of international mining contracts to American companies for the extraction of minerals on the island, and

Whereas, U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio has suggested that the United States may be interested in purchasing Greenland from Denmark, but that President Trump is still considering military options; in either case, the Trump Administration has displayed a blatant disregard for the sovereignty of Greenland and Denmark and for the centrality of NATO in European and Arctic security, *now therefore be it*

Resolved by the Senate and House of Representatives:

That the General Assembly expresses strong support for the existing U.S.-Denmark treaty related to Greenland and opposes any American effort to secure sovereignty over the island, *and be it further*

Resolved: That the Secretary of State be directed to send a copy of this resolution to President Donald J. Trump, U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio, U.S. Secretary of Defense Pete Hegseth, the Vermont Congressional Delegation, the Greenland Inatsisartut, and Prime Minister Mette Frederiksen of Denmark.